

FINAL REPORT

Seventh

General Service Conference of A.A.



1957

CONFIDENTIAL

INDEX TO 1957 GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE REPORT

"THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE"	1
BILL AND THE CONFERENCE	2
BILL'S ADDRESS -- "THE NEED FOR AUTHORITY EQUAL TO RESPONSIBILITY"	3
LEONARD V. HARRISON -- THE NEW CHAIRMAN	6
REPORTS OF COMMITTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD	
General Service Board Secretary	8
Policy Committee	9
Public Information Committee	10
Literature Committee	11
REPORTS OF THE GENERAL SERVICE STAFF	
Conference Secretary	12
General Service Headquarters	13
Public Relations & Public Information	14
Group Relations	15
Institutional Groups	16
A.A. Overseas	17
Loners & Internationalists	18
REPORTS OF THE A.A. GRAPEVINE	
Grapevine (Business)	19
Grapevine Circulation	20
FINANCIAL REPORTS	
Bill's Finances	21
Chart: Groups-Income-Operating Expense	22
1957 Headquarters Budget	23
Introduction to Financial Data	24
G.S.H. - Combined Balance Sheets	25
G.S.H. - Combined Income Statement	26
RESULTS OF SURVEY OF AREA DELEGATES ON CONFERENCE ACTIVITY IN THEIR AREAS	27
PANEL DISCUSSIONS BY AREA DELEGATES	
"The Group, the Area & Their Public Relations"	28
"Clubhouses"	29
QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS & CONFERENCE ANSWERS	31
MISCELLANEOUS CONFERENCE NOTES	36
CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS	
General Service Board and Headquarters Reports	37
New By-Laws for General Service Board Approved	38
Gift Edition of A.A. Book--Special Appeal, Gratitude Week--A.A. Symbol.	39
Grapevine enlargement and price increase	40
Question of changing ratio of Trustees	40
Area Delegates Only Meeting	41
Report of Conference Committee on Finance	42
Report of Conference Committee on Grapevine	43
Report of Conference Committee on Literature	43
Report of Conference Committee on Trustees	43
Report of Conference Committee on Conference Report & Charter	44
Report of Conference Committee on Policy	44
Report of Conference Committee on Admissions to G.S.C.	45
Report of Conference Committee on Agenda	47
INDEX TO APPENDICES	48

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THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE

"Stability and Responsibility without Complacency."

Perhaps that is the way a legendary "man from Mars" might describe the current status of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous, had his knowledge of the movement been limited to observation of the Seventh General Service Conference at work.

For it seemed abundantly true that the coming of age, heralded at St. Louis two years ago, had not been voiced prematurely. In terms of numbers, services---even problems---the Society reflected in deliberations at the Commodore Hotel was a stable entity, a flourishing vine. Its roots are deep and the shelter of its branches extends virtually worldwide.

Responsibility is not a new concept at General Service Conferences. From the first meeting in 1951, Delegates have always acted responsibly and with fundamental unselfishness. The difference this year appeared to be that Delegates seemed not so much concerned with their responsibility to particular Areas or Committees "back home." The need for preserving and enhancing the structure of A.A., as a means for fulfilling the primary purpose of A.A., seemed to have a greater claim on their loyalty.

Too often in human societies, Stability and Responsibility are masks for Complacency, for the feeling that because fair weather prevails today, the barometer of "success" or achievement will remain high indefinitely. In the eyes of the world, the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous might be considered successful, its services more than adequate, its resources ample for most contingencies.

But this year's Conference was far from complacent. In more than one instance it looked ahead, with sound realism, to scan far horizons where danger or distress might lurk. In its consideration of the future of the Grapevine, in its approval of new by-laws for the General Service Board, in its searching scrutiny of Headquarters finances, in its enthusiasm for Bill's new book as a means of projecting the significance of the Third Legacy story---in all these things, and others, the Seventh Conference was far from complacent.

"A.A. is a spiritual way of life," former Chairman Bernard Smith said. "A.A. has a message for many who are not alcoholics," Leonard Harrison, this year's chairman, said. "We must remember that our Society has never yet felt the impact of a powerful, harmful force from outside the movement---a serious depression, perhaps, or catastrophic inflation," Bill said.

This was the talk of stable men, responsible men. The Delegates themselves provided the action to fit the talk. And none can be said to have voted complacently.

BILL AND THE CONFERENCE

In five specific areas of Conference interest, Bill W. made contributions to the 1957 meetings that should long be remembered within the movement and should help substantially in A.A.'s expanding relations with the "outside" world.

In each case, the contribution was one greater than that of mere words. In each case, Bill pledged time, effort and the immeasurable gift of his experience to the movement.

When, for example, he displayed "printer's copy" for the forthcoming book, "A.A. Comes of Age," his labors were still far from over in connection with publication details of a document that will help the Fellowship in two ways: It will, for the first time, in book form, set the record straight on the early days of the movement. And it will provide a unique device for explaining and interpreting the significance of the Third Legacy to the average member who has already benefited, unknowingly, from that Legacy.

When he pledged his personal writing and planning efforts to help solve the pressing dilemma confronting the Grapevine, Bill was assuring the survival of one of the vital tools available to the movement to "help carry the message to the millions who still don't know."

When he exposed his own financial position and presented to the movement a detailed accounting of all "A.A. income" received since the Society became involved in money matters, Bill was setting a bright example for all in positions of A.A. responsibility, at every level of Fellowship activity.

When he outlined his concept of the structure of A.A. as a movement keyed to four great procedural principles---Petition, Participation, Appeal and Decision---Bill also looked ahead to the day when the Third Legacy Manual will be supported by a companion document up-dating all of A.A.'s "structural" experience. And only Bill is prepared and qualified to write such a book.

When he reported to the Conference on his labors to assure the movement the best possible television documentary, he was minimizing days and weeks of work and travel whose benefits will, it is expected, be shared not only by A.A.s but by many who today have not yet learned that there is a way out.

And when he reminded the Conference of possible pitfalls ahead, he was perhaps displaying his highest loyalty to all who love him. For he was minimizing the greatness of his own vision and leadership---themselves A.A.'s best assurance that it can cope with crises ahead.

"THE NEED FOR AUTHORITY EQUAL TO RESPONSIBILITY"

The following excerpts are from Bill's address to the Conference on the importance of appreciating the place of authority and responsibility at all levels of the A.A. structure.

The Tradition of Alcoholics Anonymous in its present short form suggests that A.A. shall forever remain unorganized, that we may create special boards or committees to serve us--never governmental in character.

The Second Tradition is the source of all of the authority which, as you know, lies in the group conscience of which this Conference is the articulate voice worldwide.

Those are the basics on which our structure of service rests, whether at the group level, the intergroup or A.A. as a whole. What we want of the service is primarily to fill a need that can be met in no other way. The test of any service really is: "Is it necessary."

If it is really necessary, then provide it we must, or fail in our duty to A.A. and to those still to come. Experience has shown that certain necessary services are absolutely indispensable at all levels. We make this distinction: The movement itself is never organized in any governmental sense. A member is a member if he says so. He cannot be coerced. He cannot be compelled. In that sense we are a source of benign anarchy.

When it comes to the matter of service, the services within themselves obviously have to be organized or they won't work. Therefore the service structure of Alcoholics Anonymous and more especially of this Conference is the blueprint in which we, as flesh and blood people, operate, relate ourselves to each other and provide these needed services. And it is the evolution of this blueprint within which we function that has been my chief concern for the last dozen and a half years.

The usefulness of A.A. to us in it, and more particularly to all those still to come, even the survival of A.A., really depend very much on the soundness of our basic blueprint of relating ourselves together so A.A. can function. That is the primary thing. That is what we have come to call the structure.

Let's have a brief over-all look at our structure again. Then see at what point it may possibly need refinement and improvement. I hope we never think that the cathedral of A.A. is finished. I hope that we will always be able to refine its lines and enhance its beauty and its function.

"THE NEED FOR AUTHORITY EQUAL TO RESPONSIBILITY" (Continued)

Very obviously the unit of authority in A.A. is the A.A. group itself. That's all the "law" there is. Everything that we have here in the way of authority must come from the groups.

To create the voice of A.A.'s conscience as expressed in the groups, we meet in group assemblies. And then to obviate the usual political pressures, we choose Committeemen and Delegates by the novel methods of no personal nominations and use of a two-thirds vote.

Now arrived here, how are Delegates to be related to the Board of Trustees? It was the original parent of the groups and a hierarchy of service quite appropriate to our infancy, but one which must now become directly amenable to Delegates and those closely linked to Delegates.

That question was responsible for a great deal of thought and speculation in time past. And I think our seven years' experience has suggested that, in broad outline, we are somewhere near right.

The Board of Trustees as a hierarchy had certain great advantages, which we want to keep. For the long pull, it had immense liabilities. It was a law unto itself. (Now it must become a partner.) We have the Board, which is more or less of an appointive proposition, and the staff members and directors of services, largely appointed, subject to your consent, of course. We had the problem of how the electees are going to relate to the appointees.

In the first place, in this Conference, we put all of ourselves in the same club. The Trustee, for example, becomes a Conference member with just one vote, and a custodial duty. A Director of a service agency becomes a Conference member, with a service duty. At the level of this Conference, we are all equal; we are all in the club. And you note that the appointees have been set in a great minority to the electees to insure that Area Delegates will always have adequate powers of persuasion.

The Board of Trustees, you remember, is a legally incorporated entity. It has to be that way first of all to transact business. It has to be that way to give its several members and committees appropriate powers and titles which denote what they do. We have to have that much organization in order to function.

Theoretically, as Bernard Smith has pointed out, the Board of Trustees has been legally undisturbed by all the recent change. Nevertheless, in a Traditional and psychological sense, the Trustees' relations to the groups and to you has been profoundly altered, not because Delegates have legal power but because Trustees know that Delegates are their linkage to A.A. as a whole. They also very well know that if you don't like what they do, you can go home and cut off Area support.

"THE NEED FOR AUTHORITY EQUAL TO RESPONSIBILITY" (Continued)

In order to have anything functional, people have to have an authority to act. Very obviously there are all kinds of questions arising where the basic problem is "Who should act? And where should the committee or board or individual act, and when should he act?"

A Conference, a movement, can't actually run anything. A Board of Trustees really can't run anything. We operated on that mistaken idea for a while. We have to classify the kind of thing that each worker, each Board, does -- and the kind of thing the Conference does and the kind of thing that A.A. must do to keep this Fellowship functioning. In other words there must always be an authority equal to the responsibility involved in service work.

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LEONARD V. HARRISON -- THE "NEW" CHAIRMAN

For the first time since the Conference was established in 1951, a "new" chairman presided at key sessions of its annual meetings.

He was Mr. Leonard V. Harrison, one of A.A.'s oldest and most devoted non-alcoholic friends who succeeded to the chairmanship of the General Service Board when Mr. Bernard B. Smith stepped down last year. Mr. Smith continues as a member of the Board. As Board chairman, Mr. Harrison automatically succeeds him as chairman of the annual Conferences.

Interestingly, Mr. Harrison has twice been chairman of the General Service Board, the body that acts as custodian of A.A.'s Third Legacy of service to alcoholics throughout the world. Shortly after the Board was constituted 20 years ago (as "The Alcoholic Foundation,") Mr. Harrison was first elected to the chairmanship.

His unfailing understanding, good humor and sense of balance were important factors in steering the Board during the difficult early days of A.A. when its traditions, policies and scope of activities were not clearly defined.

During the period when the concept of the Conference was being debated vehemently, Mr. Harrison played a decisive role in the sequence of events which led to the establishment of the Conference on a trial basis in 1951.

Following this, Mr. Harrison withdrew from the Board for several years to devote time to personal affairs. He was prevailed upon to become a Trustee again when the pressure of these duties eased.

Prior to his recent retirement, Mr. Harrison was an officer of the Community Service Society of New York City, one of the oldest and best-respected welfare organizations in the country.

In his informal remarks at the dinner opening the Conference Wednesday evening, Mr. Harrison recalled briefly the early years when the Board of Trustees was attempting to develop a realistic concept of service for the expanding Fellowship of A.A. and for others throughout the world who were turning to the Society for help.

He noted that the role of non-alcoholic Trustees was still not fully understood throughout A.A.

Citing the basic harmony with which alcoholics and non-alcoholics had worked together on the Board, Mr. Harrison said that the non-alcoholics had drawn inspiration as well as knowledge from their participation in A.A. custodial affairs.

THE NEW CHAIRMAN (Continued)

In notes prepared for his closing remarks to the Delegates at the Sunday afternoon session, Mr. Harrison outlined the significance of the Seventh Conference as a milestone in the growth of the Society.

He pointed out that meetings such as these make it possible for "the beneficent effects of the A.A. movement" to be felt and enjoyed widely among persons who have not been "desolated by the harm of alcoholic addiction."

"Nearly every one knows, or knows of, some one who has made a miraculous recovery through A.A.," Mr. Harrison said.

When these "miracles" happen, the alcoholic who is rehabilitated is not the only one to find a new way of life, he noted. "Everyone who is close to, or concerned with the life of the recovered alcoholic, feels a glow of satisfaction. Everyone is encouraged and strengthened by the happiness that radiates from the person whose life had once seemed hopeless and who now has abundant hope."

In a sense, Mr. Harrison said, each individual member of A.A. is a Delegate in a great cause of character development and in extending the boundaries of humanitarianism.

He cited the ancient saying, "I wept bitter tears that I had no shoes until I met a man who had no feet" and commented that A.A.s have learned to dry their own bitter tears, have shown others how useless it is to weep and have helped many who thought they had no useful feet.

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TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

The following summarizes key actions taken by the Board of Trustees since the 1956 General Service Conference: (Other matters considered and acted upon by the Board are covered in reports of the various Committees.)

1. Elected Harrison M. Trice, Assistant Professor, School of Industrial & Labor Relations, Cornell University, Ithaca, New York as a Class A Trustee replacing Jack Alexander (resigned). This action was taken after consultation with the Nominating Committee of the General Service Conference.
2. Approved the purchase of Group Life Insurance for all employees of A.A. Publishing, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. in amounts from \$4,000 to \$10,000 depending upon salary bracket.
3. Reviewed and approved, with certain recommendations, the proposed "Memorandum of Association" of the General Service Board of A.A. in Great Britain and Ireland, Ltd. This entity is presently being organized with six A.A. Trustees and two non-alcoholic Trustees and will act for that area as a completely separate entity.
4. Amended the October, 1955, approval of the use of the A.A. symbol (initials and triangle within a circle) by the groups to provide that the words, "General Service Conference," not be used in the portrayal of the symbol as used by groups. Registration of the symbol containing the Conference wording has been obtained from the U. S. Patent Office.
5. Obtained, as protection for the Fellowship, libel insurance in the amount of \$100,000, covering all publications of A.A. Publishing, Inc.
6. Authorized negotiation for the publication of the book, "Alcoholics Anonymous" in Norwegian with full control and ownership vested in A.A. Publishing, Inc.

POLICY COMMITTEE

In his report for the G.H.S. Policy Committee, Cliff W., chairman, reviewed the reasons for creating the Committee and summarized various typical matters covered during the past year. He said the Committee, which meets on Sunday afternoons preceding Monday evening quarterly meetings of the Board of Trustees, had been extremely helpful in bringing Area Trustees up to date on matters to be discussed at Board meetings.

Cliff described the Committee's relationship to the Board and to the Conference structure.

He said the Committee was anxious to have the sense of the Conference on the problem of handling proposals submitted by Delegates during the year. While great care is taken by the Committee not to act as a censor, occasionally the Committee has felt that it would be in the interest of the movement as a Fellowship to determine, after careful review, whether or not a proposal should be circulated.

He offered for Conference consideration the following possible solution to the problem:

1. If Policy Committee feels a Proposal should not be circulated, it should be referred to Conference Agenda Committee.
2. If the Agenda Committee concurs in this feeling, the Proposal should be returned to the Delegate involved, and he should be advised of his privilege to present the Proposal, at an appropriate time, from the floor of Conference itself.

PUBLIC INFORMATION COMMITTEE

Public interest in the A.A. recovery program increased during the year and a number of Headquarters activities were developed to fill the demand for basic information on the program.

A notable project, approved by the 1956 Conference, was the creation of a portable, professional exhibit describing A.A. for use at national meetings in the fields of medicine, social welfare and law enforcement. The exhibit was displayed for the first time in June, 1956, at a meeting of the Western Division of the American Public Health Association.

Although it is designed for optional use without personal attendants, two Staff members were present, to determine reactions to the display, when the exhibit was shown at the national meeting of the A.P.H.A. in Atlantic City, New Jersey, in November, 1956. The display was one of a limited number awarded a Certificate of Merit for design and clarity in conveying a message. Conference-approved literature was distributed upon request. Approximately 800 copies each of "A.A.--44 Questions and Answers" and "Structure and Services of A.A." were requested by public health personnel.

The following display schedule has been approved for 1957:

Ninth Annual American Academy of General Practice, March 25-28, St. Louis, Mo.

Industrial Health Conference, April 20-26, St. Louis, Mo.

84th Annual Forum National Conference of Social Welfare, May 19-24, Philadelphia.

American Hospital Association, September 30, October 3, Atlantic City, N.J.

During the year, the Committee supervised production and distribution of a "Basic Fact File" on A.A. for editors, writers and researchers. Approximately 300 magazine and newspaper editors were advised of the availability of the "File." The first experimental printing of 250 copies has been nearly exhausted and a second printing approved. It has been recommended that the "File" be available for purchase by local groups, through A.A. Publishing, Inc.

Future distribution of the "File" will be in accordance with the following basic policy, which has been approved by the General Service Board: When a writer requests help on an article for a specific publication, a copy of the "File" is to be handed personally to the appropriate editor of the magazine, as well as to the writer, whenever possible; when a publication carries an article on A.A. without prior notice to G.S.H., or when a publication identifies an A.A. member by name, the appropriate G.S.H. staff member may get in touch with the publication and review the "Basic Fact File" with publishers, editors or writers, if possible.

As authorized by the 1956 Conference, the Committee has also met a number of times with Bill to review developments in the project involving a proposed National Broadcasting Company television program on A.A.

Editorial, radio and television background material, originally prepared at the request of the 1953 Conference, was up-dated and expanded during the year.

LITERATURE COMMITTEE

The Literature Committee supervises the writing, editing and production of virtually all non-textbook printed material distributed by G.S.H. as part of its service to members and groups throughout the world, Cal M., Committee chairman reported. Material is prepared only in answer to specific requests from the movement or to fill needs which Headquarters has been authorized to handle by the Conference.

Assignments carried out during the past year under Committee supervision included production of the monthly "A.A. Exchange Bulletin," up-dating and revision of existing pamphlets and folders, preparation of the 1956 Conference Report and the special "Conference Highlights" four-page digest for the groups, revision of the Handbook section in the 1957 Directory, preparation of Interim Reports distributed to Conference personnel, writing and production of a new pamphlet, "Cooperation-Yes; Affiliation-No!" for distribution to groups in Norway, writing and production of "Basic Fact File" in accordance with specifications of the Public Information Committee and the preparation of three special reprints excerpting A.A. publications.

No new pamphlets were prepared during the past year but it was noted that distribution of a number of existing items reached all-time highs. The small folder, "Is A.A. for You?," announced for the first time in May, 1956, proved exceptionally popular. More than 86,000 copies were distributed during the year and a new printing of 100,000 copies has recently come off the press. More than 85,000 copies of "This is A.A." and more than 72,000 copies of "A.A.--44 Questions and Answers" were also distributed by G.S.H.

Consideration has also been given to the need for two new pamphlets, subject to the approval of the 1957 Conference Committee on Literature.

It was emphasized that the above activities are exclusive of Bill's continuing activities in the field of basic book literature for the movement.

REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE SECRETARY

A growing interest in Conference matters and more efficient handling of the Conference structure in local Areas were 1956 highlights noted by Ann M., Conference Secretary in her report. Supporting this analysis, Ann cited the number of Assembly meetings conducted in accordance with the Third Legacy Manual, better reporting of Assembly meetings to local groups by State Committees, increased use of local newsletters to carry the Conference story to individual members and more effective use of Headquarters material dealing with the Conference.

The Conference structure seems to be understood and appreciated best in Areas where large, strong Area Committees are functioning. Most Areas have increased the number of Committeemen in recent years; Conference mailings have jumped from 5,521 in 1954 to 8,624 in 1957.

The report, a brief summary of the history of the Conference from the time it was suggested to the groups in 1950 to the present, also pointed out that some A.A. areas are not as yet "too interested" in the Third Legacy.

Puerto Rico, the first A.A. Area outside the continental U.S. and Canada to have representation at the Conference, will retain its distinctive status this year. Although U.S. territories and possessions were admitted as a part of the Conference last year, Alaska and Hawaii have deferred sending a Delegate.

As approved by the Conference last year, Missouri has additional representation in the 1957 Conference.

The report stressed the importance of having Delegates, in those States and Provinces where there are more than one Delegate, define the Areas they serve. It is felt that Headquarters can serve the interested Delegates and groups more efficiently if it has in G.S.H. Conference files an exact listing of the groups in each Delegate's area. It would be desirable to refine this listing to show the names of groups served by individual members of the Area Committee.

Since the last Conference, one proposal has been referred to the Delegates for Area consideration.

GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS OPERATIONS

Increased demands upon General Service Headquarters during 1956 are reflected in nearly all statistical data covering office operations, according to Hank G., coordinating chairman of the Headquarters activity.

INCOMING MAIL ITEMS	37,230
(Inquiries, Group Communications, Contributions, etc.)	
OUTGOING MAIL ITEMS	143,517
(Including Monthly Bulletins - 8,500 per month)	
PACKAGES WRAPPED AND SHIPPED	21,116
(30,654 books, 602,536 pamphlets, 265 record sets, 199,427 wallet cards)	

The Accounting Department processed 8,098 orders for books, pamphlets, etc., and handled 6,223 contribution remittances.

Distribution of Books, Pamphlets and Miscellaneous Items in 1956

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous (Old Edition) . . .	107
Alcoholics Anonymous (Revised Edition) .	23,468
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions . . .	7,079

Total Books Shipped 30,654

Pamphlets (Continued)

Good Housekeeping Reprint .	25,680
The Third Legacy Manual . .	3,950
Foreign Translations . . .	8,179

Total Pamphlets Shipped. 602,536

Pamphlets

This is A.A.	85,733
A.A.--44 Questions and Answers	72,264
Is A.A. for You?	86,386
Young People and A.A.	27,940
A.A. for the Woman	29,990
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed . . .	19,568
Sponsorship	24,912
Alcoholism the Illness	38,467
The Alcoholic Husband	17,359
The Alcoholic Wife	29,005
The Alcoholic Employee	22,850
A.A. and the Medical Profession	24,875
Sedatives and the Alcoholic	25,067
Saturday Evening Post Reprint	33,582
Fortune Reprint	26,729

Miscellaneous

Wallet Cards	199,427
Parchment Scrolls	379
Lasker Award Replicas . . .	30
Books - A.A. - Spanish . .	208

Records

A.A.'s Traditions	57
Dr. Bob's Last Major Talk (Dis.)	82
A.A.'s Three Legacies . . .	67
Milestones Ahead	59

Total Record Sets Shipped 265

Twenty-nine persons are employed at Headquarters, in the following categories: A.A. Staff (7); Stenographic. filing, telephone and reception (11); Bookkeeping (4) and Shipping (7).

PUBLIC RELATIONS AND PUBLIC INFORMATION SERVICE

Anonymity breaks in newspapers and magazines during 1956 appeared to be far fewer than during the previous year, according to Lib. S., reporting on the strengthening of G.S.H. Public Relations and Public Information Service. It was suggested that the decrease may have been the result of the special mailing on anonymity that went to 6,500 communications people in the U.S. and Canada in October, 1955. The mailing included the 1955 Conference resolution on anonymity and a covering letter signed by the then chairman of the General Service Board.

Other highlights of Public Relations Service activities during the year included:

1. Obtaining five 16-millimeter prints of the Loretta Young television show, featuring A.A.'s role as an aid to health programs in industry
2. Surveying reaction to the A.A. exhibit during its showing at the national convention of the American Public Health Association
3. Arranging for donations of A.A. books to professionals working with alcoholics overseas (Czechoslovakia, Yugoslavia, Poland, Rumania, Portugal, Sudan, Africa, Lebanon and Iran)
4. Arranging for displays of A.A. books and other literature at meetings of: National Council on Family Relations, Yale University Summer School of Alcohol Studies, American Medical Association Bureau of Health Education, National Association of Mental Hospital Chaplains and a meeting sponsored by a State Hospital and State Department of Welfare.
5. Interviewing several authors preparing magazine articles and providing copies of "Basic Fact File," approving quotation of A.A. text material in several cases
6. Reviewing several hundred articles on A.A. and on alcoholism from English-language press throughout world

An important part of the public relations activity involved cooperation with Area Delegates who consulted with G.S.H. on planning of local television shows or who requested that special material or letters be sent to their Areas. In several cases, G.S.H. was asked to make clear to local newspaper publishers that A.A. does not endorse or oppose legislation on alcoholism. Background editorial material and "pattern" radio and television scripts were sent, upon request, to 135 groups.

Six letters were written to commercial institutions asking them to respect the A.A. Directory as a confidential document, for A.A. use only.

Some measure of the status of A.A.'s public relations during the past year is suggested by the caliber and scope of magazines carrying articles on the movement: American Journal of Psychiatry, Journal of the American Medical Association, Today's Health, Mental Hygiene, Practical Nurses Digest, National Tuberculosis Association publication, Kiwanis Magazine, Williams College Alumni News, Transit (NYC Transit Authority), City Hotel Reporter and AFL-CIO Local 425 News.

GROUP RELATIONS

Defining "group relations" as relating groups to each other and to the fellowship as a whole, as well as relating Headquarters service to all A.A. groups, Eve M. of the G.S.H. staff pointed that the number of groups listed in the Directory has grown from 4,025 in 1951, the first Conference year, to 6,779 early in 1957. A total of 1,071 new groups and loners were registered last year alone; 541 listings were "deactivated."

During the past year a "simplified" registration card was used in the mailing to get up-to-date listings for the 1957 Directory. Sixty-two percent of the cards were returned, an increase of 10% over the returns for the previous year. As a result of continuing analysis of the problem, an even simpler Directory registration card is being designed for future use. In addition, a group will automatically be inactivated if G.S.H. has had no contact with the group during the previous year via Directory card, new registration, letter, order, contribution or listing by a Delegate, Committeeman or local Intergroup.

In the new Directory, 38% of the groups list their General Service Representative, 25% list the secretary and the remaining 37% list other individuals or a P.O. Box. Nearly 70% of the groups have asked that mail be sent to the P.O. Box or to the secretary. Slightly more than 30% designate the G.S.R. to receive mail, which accords with Headquarters observation that G.S.R.s are frequently not active in their groups.

Headquarters has been asked for background information and summaries of experience on many problems during the past year. Three typical problems recurred with some frequency:

1. Clubs: (290 registered at G.S.H.) Many groups have appeared to be confused as to the differences between a club and a group when questions of eligibility for membership arise.
2. Voting in Group Business Meetings: Some "members feel that they are members of A.A. as a whole" and therefore eligible to vote in more than one group's business meetings.
3. Formation of Intergroup Committees and Service Offices: Several groups have sought information dealing with problems of structure and service.

There are 37 young people's groups registered, 95 women's groups, 9 American Indian groups, 36 TB hospital groups, 105 Central offices, 76 armed forces groups and 34 armed forces loners---indicating the scope of specialized A.A. experience G.S.H. can make available to the movement.

Response to the new "A.A. Exchange Bulletin," developed just prior to the 1956 Conference, has been excellent" in certain areas but there is evidence that in "too many cases" group members do not know the "Bulletin" is being published.

(Anita R. and Jane F. of the Headquarters Staff also reported on Group Relations.)

INSTITUTIONAL GROUPS (PRISONS AND HOSPITALS)

Prison groups have increased 377% and Hospital groups 151% since 1951, according to Hazel R. Latest tabulations showed 296 prison groups with 12,836 members and 256 hospital groups with 5,936 members.

Highlights of Headquarters service to Institutional groups included:

1. Development of improved special directories for such groups, since it has been considered impracticable to list them in the large A.A. Directory.
2. Survey of Hospital groups for information on group activity, as basis for sharing A.A. experience in this field.
3. Survey of Hospital administrators to determine their experience with A.A. and their reactions to it, as basis for strengthening service in this field.
4. Review of Institutional publications, upon request.
5. Special presentations by a Staff member at meetings in prisons and hospitals.

The above activities were supplemented by voluminous correspondence with groups in institutions, with administrators and officials, with Area Committees and with members of local groups interested in developing sponsorship programs. Headquarters continued to provide free literature at the time a new group is registered and also extended its offer of special literature "packages" at reduced rates.

Trends noted during the year were summarized as follows:

1. A growing acceptance of A.A. therapy by institutional administrators
2. Increasing interest on the part of "outside" agencies in institutional A.A. (National Tuberculosis Association, probation authorities, judges etc.)
3. Development of sponsorship programs within institutional groups and evidence that closed meetings are being used more effectively by such groups.
4. Expanding interest of A.A. State and Provincial Committees in Institutional work, with a corollary growth of "outside" sponsorship programs.

A unique development during the year was the announcement that in two penitentiaries (McNeil Island in the State of Washington and Rio Piedras in Puerto Rico) special rehabilitation programs for non-alcoholics are being developed along the basic lines of the A.A. program. A.A. groups have been active in both institutions.

Delegates have several opportunities and responsibilities in this field, if A.A. is to be effective:

1. Let institutional authorities, as well as local A.A. members, know of the Headquarters services available to hospital and prison groups.
2. Let Headquarters know of all pertinent developments so that new groups can be registered and all groups helped.
3. Encourage hospital group sponsorship as a basic Twelfth Step Activity.

A.A. OVERSEAS

A.A. overseas has increased both numerically and in stability during the past year, Ann M. and Hazel R. indicated in their reports to the Conference.

The following capsule case histories were outlined:

1. In 1947 A.A. in England, Scotland and Eire consisted of two groups and one loner. By January, 1957 there were 114 groups and 10 loners in the same area. Four intergroups have been charted in England alone, where the Second Annual A.A. Convention will be held this year (May). Scottish A.A. held its first convention in mid-April. An English "General Service Board" and A.A. Publishing organization, patterned after prototypes in New York, are being formed in London and A.A. acceptance among outside agencies is growing.
2. In Africa, Asia, Europe, North America (excluding Conference areas) and South America, the number of members has increased from 3,654 in 1951 to 8,223 in 1957. In Africa alone, the increase for the period has been from one group with 19 members to 81 groups with 1,769 members. In many areas, local members are translating portions of the Big Book for local use. Plans for an Intergroup office are well under way in Puerto Rico. In areas as far removed as Trinidad, (British West Indies) and Norway, Headquarters has been of special service in developing material relating to strengthening of "Traditional" A.A. but this problem may require further studies in various parts of the world for some years to come. A.A. in Holland has its own newsletter and literature and has been able to provide some material to a group in the Netherlands Antilles, halfway around the world.
3. In all of Australia, New Zealand and Oceania in 1947 there were just two groups and one loner. Today in the same area there are 204 groups and 33 loners. There is a distinct trend toward converting Intergroup Committees to Central Offices, five of which are currently in operation in Australia. The number of institutional groups is increasing and sponsoring programs in this field are developing fairly rapidly. Two state-wide conventions, one of which attracted 1,200 persons, have already been held and in All-Australia convention is planned for 1958.

As A.A. overseas continues to expand, the number of requests to G.S.H. for summaries of A.A. experience in various fields has mounted. Overseas areas seek information on setting up Central Offices, on activating groups in hospitals and prisons and on handling public relations problems. It has been observed that nearly all overseas groups encounter most of the problems that faced A.A. in the U.S. and Canada in the early days of the movement. While some groups are still deviating from Traditional concepts of A.A., experience in many areas provides hope for believing that this is only a temporary phenomenon.

LONERS AND INTERNATIONALISTS

Loners and Internationalists continued to be important factors in "planting seeds of A.A. groups" in many areas, several Staff members noted in their reports to the Conference. Nearly 300 lone members and approximately 150 Internationalists are registered at Headquarters.

A special service to these isolated A.A.s during the past year has been the development of a new type of Directory for each category.

Following are capsule case histories suggesting how Headquarters, as a clearinghouse of information for all A.A.s, has been able to help isolated alcoholics in various parts of the world:

1. In Mombasa, Kenya, Africa, G.S.H. wrote to an "interested" alcoholic at the suggestion of an Internationalist member. The alcoholic registered as a Loner. One week later another inquiry developed in the same area. The inquiry was turned over to the Loner and now a new group is pending.
2. In New Delhi, India, in March, 1956, a doctor wrote to G.S.H. seeking information on A.A. Literature was mailed to him. A month later, an alcoholic who had consulted the doctor and had been given A.A. literature registered as a Loner. In January of 1957 a Canadian member who had obtained names of A.A. contacts from G.S.H. arrived in New Delhi. He discovered two Loners who had not been overly successful on their own. The Canadian and the Indians placed an announcement advertisement in a local paper. Result: 30 replies, and a new group with five members registered on March 1.
3. In Abu Suwier, Egypt (Siani Desert), a member of the Canadian army, a Loner himself, was put in touch via G.S.H. with another Loner early in March of this year. Three weeks later a group with three members, "expecting an early increase in membership," registered with G.S.H.

THE A.A. GRAPEVINE
(Business)

The report of The A.A. Grapevine was made in a special presentation in which Bill W. took part along with Russ C., business manager, and Louise S., representing Editor Don G.

Reviewing the Grapevine Committee Plan adopted at the 1956 Conference, Russ reported that circulation rose by 10,000 copies monthly to a total of 41,400, a gain of 33 1/3 percent. The number of groups receiving bulk subscriptions increased from 30 to 46 per cent of the total. Despite record circulation and income, increased costs of producing the magazine resulted in a budgetary deficit of \$14,000 for the year.

In addition to developing long-range plans for strengthening the magazine, the Directors had taken the initiative in planning for an expanded Grapevine, with a price increase to be effective July 1, 1957, Bill told the Delegates. He assured them that he would be taking an active part in Grapevine affairs during the year.

In connection with steps taken prior to the 1957 Conference to ease The Grapevine's financial problems, Bill pointed out:

1. Prior Conferences had already gone on record that the price of the magazine should be raised as soon as it became evident that increased circulation could not solve its financial problem.
2. The need for a price increase had become inescapably evident.
3. The Grapevine Directors agreed unanimously that an increase in price had to be accompanied by an increase in size.
4. Time was absolutely of the essence. The increase in price and size had to follow the Conference as quickly as possible, to prevent a costly rush for subscriptions at the lower price, as occurred when similar action was taken years ago.
5. Preparations for the July 1 "new Grapevine" had to begin before the Conference. (This involved taking on an extra editorial staff member and other help which would have been required in any case. The circulation department, badly understaffed, had only one more worker at 44,000 circulation than it had had years ago at 15,000 circulation. The editorial department did not even have a stenographer.)

"Therefore," Bill concluded, "It was only because of previous Conference declarations and the urgency of the situation that action was taken prior to the '57 Conference. Actually, the questions had long been under debate and a policy guide had been well established in former years."

Delegates to the Conference endorsed unanimously the decision to increase the price of the Grapevine from 25 cents to 35 cents for single copies, and from \$2.50 to \$3.50 for annual subscriptions in the U.S. and Canada, with proportionate increases for sales in other countries.

CIRCULATION OF THE A.A. GRAPEVINE

CIRCULATION BREAKDOWN APRIL 1st, 1957

UNITED STATES

<u>State</u>	<u>Ind.</u>	<u>Pd. Bulk</u>	<u>Mo. Bulk</u>	<u>Total</u>	<u>State</u>	<u>Ind.</u>	<u>Pd. Bulk</u>	<u>Mo. Bulk</u>	<u>Total</u>
Alabama	138	46	98	282	South Carolina	104	58	195	357
Arizona	126	67	70	263	South Dakota	130	12	91	233
Arkansas	242	62	97	401	Tennessee	143	17	140	300
California	1849	1190	1483	4522	Texas	880	289	586	1755
Colorado	257	77	63	397	Utah	206	32	74	312
Connecticut	193	82	252	527	Vermont	58	88	56	202
Delaware	46	64	11	121	Virginia	373	154	249	776
Dist. of Col.	329	23	14	366	Washington	250	121	253	624
Florida	519	170	539	1228	West Virginia	118	44	127	289
Georgia	141	93	190	424	Wisconsin	390	135	268	793
Idaho	88	76	44	208	Wyoming	59	16	27	102
Illinois	798	194	620	1612	Totals	16518	6334	13215	36067
Indiana	343	177	280	800					
Iowa	289	77	268	634					
Kansas	305	155	68	528					
Kentucky	193	22	102	317					
Louisiana	144	43	183	370					
Maine	71	36	140	247					
Maryland	360	62	96	518					
Massachusetts	1071	161	196	1428					
Michigan	816	378	577	1771					
Minnesota	608	154	239	1001					
Mississippi	90	31	131	252					
Missouri	482	100	149	731					
Montana	114	56	27	197					
Nebraska	129	69	56	254					
Nevada	35	25	36	96					
New Hampshire	55	44	42	141					
New Jersey	271	209	997	1477					
New Mexico	114	24	59	197					
New York	1038	506	2135	3679					
North Carolina	242	175	428	845					
North Dakota	99	18	27	144					
Ohio	935	272	610	1817					
Oklahoma	285	53	163	501					
Oregon	174	68	183	425					
Pennsylvania	735	303	454	1492					
Rhode Island	83	6	22	111					

CANADA

Alberta	186	23	178	387
British Col.	227	115	205	547
Manitoba	90	39	243	372
New Brunswick	29	20	109	158
Newfoundland	21	2	4	27
Nova Scotia	48	23	165	236
Northwest Ter.	1	2		3
Ontario	381	305	772	1458
Prince Edward Is.	6		23	29
Quebec	111	16	259	386
Saskatchewan	165	30	79	274
Yukon Ter.			6	6
Totals	1265	575	2043	3883
U.S. Possessions	78	97	22	197
Foreign	431	254		685
Totals	509	351	22	882
Grand Totals	18292	7260	15280	40832

BILL'S FINANCES

From the time of the first Conference, Bill W. has constantly affirmed the principle that his financial status relative to the Fellowship of A.A. should be subject to the scrutiny of any Delegate or other interested member of the movement. Even when no questions concerning this matter were raised by Delegates, Bill has taken the initiative in describing his sources of income.

At the 1957 Conference, Bill read to the Delegates the following letter addressed to Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board.

Dear Archie:

As many are aware, I have long felt that my personal finances should always be an open book to our membership.

Ever since 1951, when the General Service Conference first met, my book royalties and my expense allowances have been shown in each year's audit. This practice will of course be continued.

This year, however, I would like to make a full accounting for all monies received by me from 1938, when the Alcoholic Foundation was created, to 1955 when, at St. Louis, the Conference and its General Service Board assumed final responsibility for A.A.'s world affairs.

This seventeen-year audit has been prepared by Mr. Wilbur Smith, our CPA, and is here enclosed. Saving the small amounts I received as a result of Mr. Rockefeller's 1940 dinner, it can be seen that my whole income over those years has derived only from A.A. Publishing activities. My other services to the Headquarters were all volunteer.

I earnestly recommend that this detailed accounting be always shown to every Conference Delegate on request; and further that a copy of this audit be placed on permanent file at the New York Headquarters where, on request, it can be read by any visiting A.A. member.

Ever yours,

Bill

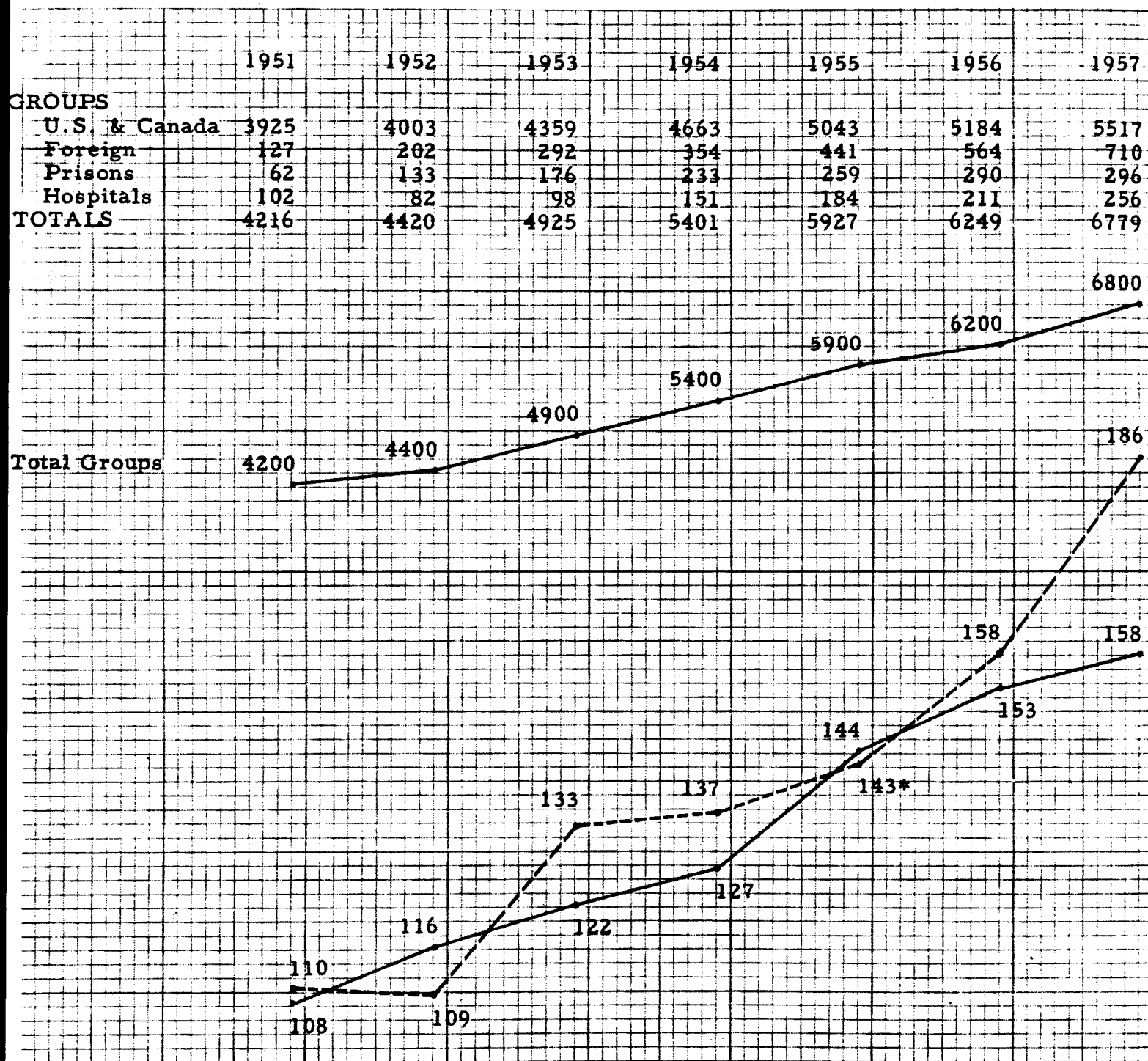
(Signed in full)

WGW/mw

P.S. I hope that the Conference sees fit to publish this letter each year in its annual report.

Chart Showing Growth of A.A. - 1951-1957

And Trend of Contributions and Expenses



————— Contributions, including G.S. Conference Appeal (Discontinued in 1956)
 - - - - - A.A. Office (Group Fund) and G.S. Conference expenses
 * Exclusive of 20th Annual Convention Deficit - St. Louis - \$16,000

1957 HEADQUARTERS BUDGET

The budget for 1957 operations of General Service Headquarters, exclusive of the A.A. Grapevine, is submitted herewith:

ESTIMATED CONTRIBUTIONS, GROSS PROFITS, AND OPERATING EXPENSES

	<u>Receipts</u>	<u>Expenses</u>	<u>Net Income</u>	<u>Net (Deficit)</u>
General Service Headquarters.... (Contributions)	\$158,000	\$186,600 *		(\$28,600)
A.A. Publishing, Inc. (Gross Profit)	104,000 **	75,300	28,700	
General Service Board.....	<u> </u>	<u>20,100</u>	<u> </u>	<u>(20,100)</u>
TOTALS	<u>\$262,000</u>	<u>\$282,000</u>	<u>\$28,700</u>	<u>(\$48,700)</u>

NET ESTIMATED DEFICIT - (\$20,000) ***

* Including Cost of General Service Conference \$22,000

** Based Upon Sales of - 23,000 books "Alcoholics Anonymous"
(Total income less 7,000 " "12 Steps & 12 Traditions"
printing & royalty expense) Averaged - Pamphlets & Miscellaneous

*** Exclusive of Reserve Fund Appreciation of \$17,500
(from Book Discounts and Interest)

Also submitted is a tabulation of the growth in the number of groups as reported in the Group Directories from 1951 through 1957.

It will be seen that the increase in Group Contributions has not kept pace with the increase in the number of reported groups and the necessary increase in expenses. The number of registered groups has increased over this period by 62%, while the contributions were increasing by only 46%.

Over the same period expenses have increased by 69% of which 13.4% represents the fall in the purchasing power of the dollar (according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics). The balance of the increase represents the cost of servicing 62% additional groups as well as the cost of additional services.

The budget submitted above should be studied in the light of the full scope of G.S.H. activities, as outlined in the reports of Staff members, presented in another section of this report.

INTRODUCTION TO FINANCIAL DATA

Operations of A.A.'s Headquarters service agencies resulted in net income of \$9,117 in 1956, as compared with a net loss of \$13,948 in 1955.

A.A. Publishing earned \$31,652, of which \$20,000 was paid in dividends to the General Fund. The A.A. Grapevine lost \$11,851 in its successful efforts to expand its circulation.

Group contributions totalled \$152,800 which, with \$13,200 carried over from 1955 and allocated to the costs of the 1956 Conference, resulted in an excess of \$8,000 in contributions over expenses.

The above figures are exclusive of additions of \$16,400 to the Reserve Fund. This increase and a reduction of \$10,000 in liabilities were the most notable changes in the financial position during 1956.

"Exhibit A" attached is a Combined Balance Sheet for A.A.'s Headquarters service agencies as of December 31, 1956 and 1955.

"Exhibit B" is combined income statement of the agencies for the years 1956 and 1955.

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS PUBLISHING, INC.
THE ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEETS
 DECEMBER 31, 1956 AND 1955

	DECEMBER 31, 1956					DECEMBER 31, 1955				
	General Service Board General	Office	A. A. Publishing	A. A. Grapevine	Total	General Service Board General	Office	A. A. Publishing	A. A. Grapevine	Total
ASSETS										
Cash, except Reserve Fund	\$13,460	\$31,211	\$13,979	\$28,094	\$86,744	\$12,831	\$34,567	\$10,838	\$26,171	\$84,407
Accounts receivable			7,287	1,927	9,214			5,496	3,459	8,955
Inventories			48,100		48,100			53,500		53,500
Prepaid expenses	1,161		2,501	7,694	11,356	452	349	1,947	7,060	9,808
Furniture and equipment			1	3,884	3,885			1	3,566	3,567
RESERVE FUND - in cash	146,762		802		147,564	130,363		840		131,203
Inter-company accounts:										
Advances	12,372		14,306		(C)	32,410		12,783		(E)
Less reserve for loss	(11,570)				(D)					
Investments	501				(E)	501				(G)
Total Assets	\$162,686	\$ 31,211	\$ 86,976	\$ 41,599	\$306,863	\$176,557	\$ 34,916	\$ 85,405	\$ 40,256	\$291,440
LIABILITIES										
Accounts and accruals payable	\$ 34	\$	\$ 1,770	\$ 9,881	\$ 11,685	\$	\$	\$ 11,813	\$ 4,584	\$ 16,397
Deferred income				44,154	44,154	13,240			36,256	49,496
Inter-company accounts payable		14,306	802	11,570	(C)	32,783	840		11,570	(E)
Total Liabilities	\$ 34	\$ 14,306	\$ 2,572	\$ 65,605	\$ 55,839	\$ 46,023	\$ 12,653	\$ 52,410	\$ 52,410	\$ 65,893
NET WORTH										
Capital stock outstanding			500	1	(E)			500	1	(E)
Accumulated Income:										
Balance, January 1, less Reserve Fund	45,354	(11,107)	72,252	(12,155)	94,344	64,518	(11,107)	69,027	(14,146)	108,292
Income for year - Exhibit B	(18,696)	8,012	31,652	(11,851)	9,117	(39,164)	None	23,225	1,991	(13,948)
Adjustment for inter-company advances - Note B	(31,570)	20,000			(D)					
Inter-company dividends	20,000		(20,000)			20,000		(20,000)		
RESERVE FUND - Note A	147,564				147,564	131,203				131,203
Balance, December 31	\$162,652	\$ 16,905	\$ 83,904	(\$24,006)	\$251,025	\$176,557	(\$ 11,107)	\$ 72,252	(\$ 12,155)	\$225,547
Total Liabilities and Net Worth	\$162,686	\$ 31,211	\$ 86,976	\$ 41,599	\$306,863	\$176,557	\$ 34,916	\$ 85,405	\$ 40,256	\$291,440

NOTE A - RESERVE FUND

	1956	1955
Balance, beginning of period	\$131,203	\$108,632
Book discounts donated	12,316	19,355
Interest on Savings Accounts	4,045	3,216
Balance, December 31	<u>\$147,564</u>	<u>\$131,203</u>

*NOTE B - The General Service Conference voted in 1951 that the deficits incurred in the years 1949 and 1950 amounting to \$20,000 should be a continuing obligation of the A.A. Groups. For bookkeeping purposes, this amount has been removed from this statement, pending repayment from the Group Contribution Fund.

Includes provision of \$11,570 for possible loss in collection of advances made to The A.A. Grapevine in the years 1947-50.

() denotes red figures.

NOTES C, D and E - Elimination of offsetting inter-company balances.

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS PUBLISHING, INC.
THE ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.

COMBINED INCOME STATEMENT
TWELVE MONTHS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1956 and 1955

	YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1956					YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1955				
	General Service Board	A.A.	A.A.			General Service Board	A.A.	A.A.		
	General	Office	Publishing	Grapevine	Total	General	Office	Publishing	Grapevine	Total
WE RECEIVED FROM:										
Sales of Books:										
Alcoholics Anonymous			\$79,841		\$79,841			\$86,481		\$86,481
12 Steps and 12 Traditions			15,749		15,749			14,647		14,647
Sales of pamphlets, etc.			77,124		77,124			64,883		64,883
Sales and subscriptions - Grapevine				\$108,952	108,952				\$96,571	96,571
Total Sales					281,666					262,582
Group Contributions										
Current Year		\$152,839			152,839		\$121,621			121,621
From deferred Conference income		13,240			13,240	\$ 9,493				9,493
Total Income		\$166,079	172,714	108,952	447,745	9,493	121,621	166,011	96,571	393,696
WE SPENT FOR:										
Cost of products sold			50,716	44,465	95,181			54,637	38,932	93,569
Royalties on books			18,444		18,444			19,963		19,963
Shipping and mailing			12,855	11,673	24,528			13,391	9,843	23,234
Salaries		81,794	26,428	33,546	141,768		75,808	24,536	29,131	129,475
Writing and Public Relations	708	2,901	3,965		7,574			2,184		2,184
Legal and accounting	2,579		3,082	1,200	6,861	1,400		2,100	1,325	4,825
Honorarium	2,000				2,000	2,000				2,000
Rent	1,200	12,425	5,552	2,400	21,577	1,200	12,307	5,438	2,400	21,345
Printing	1,714	20,099			21,813	2,780	17,256			20,036
Stationery and supplies		3,853		5,207	9,060		3,347		4,197	7,544
Telephone and telegraph		2,777		723	3,500		2,734		945	3,679
New equipment and depreciation		2,075	2,228	760	5,063		812	54	657	1,523
Other office expenses	388	5,680	899	5,347	12,314		5,779	1,079	2,742	9,600
Insurance	351	1,579			1,930	326	440			766
Taxes		2,821	485	1,246	4,552		3,138	426	1,492	5,056
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	5,025	1,366		908	7,299	4,022				4,022
Writing and Research			12,596		12,596			15,191		15,191
Bedford Hills expense			3,812		3,812			3,787		3,787
Promotion				13,328	13,328				2,916	2,916
Conference expenses		20,697			20,697	20,935				20,935
Net cost of 1955 Convention						15,994				15,994
Public Information Committee					2,016					
Television Program	2,016				2,016					
	2,715				2,715					
Total Costs and Expenses	\$ 18,696	\$158,067	\$141,062	\$120,803	\$438,628	\$ 48,657	\$121,621	\$142,786	\$ 94,580	\$407,644
Excess of Income (Expense)	(\$ 18,696)	\$ 8,012	\$ 31,652	(\$ 11,851)	\$ 9,117	(\$ 39,164)	None	\$ 23,225	\$ 1,991	(\$ 13,948)

See Note A on Exhibit A for additions to Reserve Fund

() denotes red figures.

RESULTS OF SURVEY OF AREA DELEGATES ON CONFERENCE ACTIVITY IN THEIR AREAS

All Delegates were asked to fill out a questionnaire designed to provide a general picture of the scope of Conference affairs in the Areas. Here's what the tabulation of the first 71 questionnaires showed:

1. Practically 100% of Areas followed "Third Legacy" in selecting Delegates.
2. Groups represented at Assemblies were approximately 3,000.
3. Delegates feel "Manual" procedure is satisfactory. (1 exception)
4. Only two suggestions for changing procedures were made.
5. Delegates had nearly all served in many, many A.A. jobs.
6. Delegates felt their predecessors had, in general, given good--occasionally excellent--reports on Conference; some reports not too comprehensive, however.
7. A total of 1,206 groups have specifically planned reports on Conference; others undoubtedly will make similar requests.
8. Most Delegates will make their reports in May.
9. 47 of the Delegates had not been asked to bring any particular matter to attention of the Conference.
10. All Delegates plan to use at least two of following in making reports: Meetings, Special Bulletins, Letters, A.A. Publications. Meetings are the most popular device by far.
11. Area Committee had helped defray Delegates' travel expenses to and from Conference in 68 cases. (Some Delegates not sure.)
12. In 40 cases, Area Committees have set aside funds for Conference work after Delegate returns to Area; no funds available to 30.
13. 40 Delegates had no comments on how Conference structure might be made more useful locally. Suggestions: More discussions of structure at district and state meetings, more discussion of group problems, more repeated information on Conference by Delegates.
14. Very few Delegates had heard criticism of G.S.H. services.
15. All but 8 Delegates had been receiving "Exchange Bulletin" regularly; prevailing opinion was: "I like it fine."
16. Many Delegates were not sure of Institutional A.A. picture in Areas.
17. In 60% of cases, local Central Offices guide institutional work.
18. Knowledge of Area radio and television programs on A.A. was "spotty."
19. 19 Delegates thought recent publicity on A.A. in Area was unusually good, 29 thought it was satisfactory; 19 said there was "not much of it."
20. Area A.A. participates in all types of public programs.
21. Doctors, ministers and others generally refer alcoholics to A.A. in most Areas.

"THE GROUP, THE AREA AND THEIR PUBLIC RELATIONS"

Delegates from Kentucky, Eastern Michigan, Saskatchewan, Canada, Montana and San Diego, California took part in a stimulating, fast-moving series of presentations of Area experience in the field of public relations.

The session was chaired by Dr. John L. Norris, non-alcoholic Trustee of the General Service Board, who pointed out that the movement's public relations appear to be developing in a mature manner. Dr. Norris emphasized the importance of working closely with doctors to be sure they are familiar with A.A. and with "recoveries" achieved by their own patients.

Excerpts from comments of the participating Delegates follow:

Kentucky

Groups have been notably successful in getting media cooperation, particularly that of press in small communities. Governor A. B. Chandler is "100% behind A.A." State has film on alcoholism, with reference to A.A., that it makes available to groups. An increasing number of church groups appear to be coming to A.A. for help. Anonymity is a special problem in small towns, when talks before local non-A.A. agencies are involved. This problem has been solved by "trading" speakers among neighboring communities so that an A.A. who does not wish to do so does not have to appear before a public audience in his home town.

Eastern Michigan

"Mr. Hope" television program, carried Sundays over WWJ-TV as a public service, has been strikingly successful in producing inquiries and helping newcomers to join. Show is essentially a 30-minute closed meeting featuring moderator, three men, one woman---all masked to preserve anonymity. Twelve Steps are mentioned but actual discussion never goes beyond Second Step, to avoid discouraging alcoholics who might not grasp full significance of A.A. concept of Higher Power. Telecast covers broad area, including Canada and part of Ohio, as well as Eastern Michigan. Survey has shown that more than 800 new members joined A.A. as results of first 21 programs. Telephone inquiries are handled during show by the station and by Intergroup office. No cost to local A.A.s, who have also cooperated to publicize showings of DuPont film, "One Day at a Time."

Saskatchewan, Canada

Size of Province and smallness of many communities in which A.A. is represented has made it difficult to develop effective public relations program. It is hoped that when Provincial program on alcoholism gets under way, problem may be less difficult. There is a sound base for approaching editors and radio people (television not a major factor in Area). Area agrees that anonymity assurance highly important to newcomer, although difficult to maintain in smaller towns. Important, after explaining A.A. to other agencies, not to "try to tell them how to operate."

Montana

Butte group has worked with local radio and television stations on several projects. Now arranging to have DuPont film shown locally for first time. Newspaper advertising used regularly to make availability of A.A. known. Committee of experienced A.A. "Shock Troops" can be used on local public relations projects throughout state, assisting new groups, or in other situations. Groups make use of films from State Library and from sources in Salt Lake City.

San Diego

In an Area where Intergroup represents 90% of the groups, special attention is devoted to public relations by one of four key committees. Public relations committee is only one to have specific eligibility requirements, including a minimum of three years of stable sobriety.

Committee furnishes, or gives approval to, speakers who represent A.A. at public hearings. It consults with local media on matters involving A.A. tradition. It answers inquiries from outside agencies who seek information on the recovery program. And it works with judges, Motor Vehicle Bureau officials and others, on request, to clarify problems involving A.A. Net effect of all activity is careful, mature approach to strengthening of A.A.'s second legacy: Tradition.

CLUBHOUSES

Delegates from Oregon, Northern Minnesota, Quebec, (Canada), Northeast Texas and South Florida participated in a provocative panel session on Clubhouses under the chairmanship of Icky S., a member of the Board of Trustees. Emphasizing the importance of separating the functions of clubs and groups, Icky summed up the general feeling of the participants by declaring that, in A.A., when you put your heart rather than your brains into a project, "You can go a long, long, way."

Excerpts from the presentations:

Northern Minnesota

Seven clubs in Area range from a "showplace" with 850 members and its own building to a 35-member club that rents its meeting place. Support of G.S.H. apparently not dependent on size or property-holdings, ranges from 100% of traditional \$2. contributions to exactly nothing. "Clubs have many advantages. But it is a struggle to maintain them and their value comes into question when, all too often, they seem to place other values before the primary purposes of A.A."

Northeast Texas

Tolerance has grown in recent years and members seem better able to cope with clubhouse crises. Have discovered that rotation of officers is absolutely essential. Dallas club supports G.S.H. activities and makes it a point to acquaint newcomers with "all three legacies." Tries to adhere to Traditions in all respects. Works with Al-Anon groups to extent of providing facilities, but operations of two entities are kept separate.

PANEL SESSIONS (Continued)

Oregon

Ten years ago in one city, there were two groups. Later a group "catering" to business and professional A.A.s was organized at a downtown hotel. Eventually a run-down property was acquired as a club for all A.A.s (dues \$2. to \$10, but some didn't pay and the club did not appeal to others.) Later rented a hall as a club for newcomers coming off Skid Row. A certain amount of gambling and other causes of dissension developed and an offshoot, Alcoholics Social Society, was formed.

Situation tending to get out of balance, some believe. With only 400 members in the city, combined club overhead of \$3,000 a month is involved, with another \$400 a month required for Central Office. Ratio of contributions is higher from out-of-town Area group. In one "plush" group in the city, "not a dime is set aside for G.S.H."

South Florida

Delegate described how "New Look" in clubs in Area has come about in past decade. Nine clubs in Area, 20 groups, seven women's meetings. New trend started when the "I-never-did-that" type of alcoholic began to come to A.A. Some were disturbed by "old-type" clubs, went away and never came back. Others participated in evolution to attractive, well-furnished clubhouses. Typical new club is not a "hangout," gambling joint or "lonely hearts" haven and is growing by leaps and bounds. Regular meetings are featured. There is growing awareness of need to take care of all types of alcoholics.

Montreal, Canada

Two clubs in Montreal, result of language factor. Oldest club is for English-speaking alcoholics. Other for French-speaking alcoholics in a city where two-thirds of people are French-Canadians. Both had problems with gambling.

In Quebec City, one club seemed to be going well but some members who had different ideas about club management formed a second club. In most smaller communities in Areas, with 90% of population French-speaking, all clubs are for French-Canadians. Even small cities may have unusually successful clubs. In one community of 3,000, 100 members built their own building, have a successful program of meetings and social affairs.

Problems of encouraging adequate support for G.S.H. not yet solved. Other problems (gambling, lonely hearts) still remain. But Delegate is optimistic for future.

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS

It is Traditional at all General Service Conferences to afford Delegates the widest latitude (and complete anonymity, if desired) in asking any question pertaining to operations of A.A.'s Headquarters service agencies and the Conference structure itself. A question box is available to Delegates and its contents are read at intervals. The following indicates the scope of questions asked during the 1956 Conference and the disposition of each query:

<u>Question</u>	<u>Disposition</u>
1. When an Alternate Delegate serves out the second year of a Delegate's term, what is the Alternate's status when the next selection of a Delegate is made?	The Alternate's term expires when that of the original Delegate ends. The Alternate is then <u>eligible</u> for selection to serve a new two-year term, if his Area wants him to serve.
2. Does G.S.H. plan to develop any literature for member who has been on program 2 or 3 years, now needs "sustaining" material?	Referred to Literature Committee, with suggestion that it relate to proposal for "old-timers'" pamphlet, already discussed.
3. Why not list group meeting nights in Directory?	Impractical to do this because it would make Directory too bulky, hard to handle, Staff member pointed out. Cost factor would be prohibitive. And meeting nights change frequently.
4. What should be movement policy when Secretary of a State, or Registrar of Motor Vehicles queries a group on the status of a person who has applied for restoration of a driving license, claiming adherence to A.A. program?	Delegates from Idaho, New Hampshire, Maine, Massachusetts, Maryland and Eastern and Western Pennsylvania commented on experience in their Area. It was consensus that matters of this nature are handled best on a personal, informal basis and that great care should be taken not to violate A.A. principles of anonymity where others who claim membership are involved.
5. Does G.S.H. have a film strip (or a program) for High School and College students?	Because AA's only purpose is to help alcoholics, G.S.H. refers inquiries of this type to agencies specializing in education on alcoholism. Information on several excellent films in this category are available from G.S.H. on request.

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS (Continued)

7. A syndicated columnist recently broke the anonymity of a well-known television personality. How are such writers "educated?"
- In recent years more than 7,000 writers, editors, publishers and columnists have been informed on the anonymity resolution adopted by the Conference at St. Louis. The columnist in question knows of the anonymity principle in A.A. In cases such as these, the writer is reminded of this principle. (Editor's note: Occasionally material appearing in syndicated columns is actually written by an assistant; it is not always possible to determine when a new assistant has been added to a columnist's staff.)
8. Should the case of a clergyman who exploits the Directory be discussed with his superior by the appropriate Delegate?
- Referred to Policy Committee.
9. Wouldn't round badges be better than rectangular ones for Conference Delegates?
- Referred to Conference Agenda Committee.
10. Can we start a campaign to have Loners sponsored by groups?
- This is being done. G.S.H. will be glad to help interested groups get in touch with Loners.
11. Why is the phrase "ex-alcoholics" used in the new by-laws?
- Only to satisfy the requirements for incorporation in the State of New York. Legal definitions and "A.A. definitions" both appear in the by-laws.
12. Of the 29 G.S.H. staff members, how many are A.A.s?
- Only the six girls who handle the specific responsibilities described to the Conference in G.S.H. reports are A.A. members. The policy of hiring non-A.A. members exclusively for clerical, stenographic, bookkeeping and similar jobs is followed strictly. This eliminates "politicking" to get A.A.s on the payroll and has worked out well in practice.
13. Can G.S.H. supply Area Committees with quarterly reports on group contributions?
- This can be done if each Delegate will provide an accurate list of the names and locations of groups in his Area. (In States with multiple representation, this is a continuing problem.)

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS (Continued)

14. Is it best to gamble on asking members for \$2. per year for G.S.H. or should the group send an amount from its treasury, even though this does not equal the traditional sum?
- Because this is basically a matter involving local autonomy, Delegates were asked to report Area experience. Many patterns were revealed. One, which might be called the middle of the road approach has the groups canvassing individuals for \$2. and then making up any deficit out of the group Treasury.
15. What is the answer to a group representative who feels that non-approved literature is actually "approved" by the Conference simply because G.S.H. gave him the address from which to obtain it?
- In providing information on literature issued by others, G.S.H. staff members are careful to point out that it is not approved by the Conference. It is also explained that Conference approval is intended primarily to distinguish G.S.H. literature, not censor other material.
16. Why can't we have a pocket-sized, low-cost edition of the Big Book to sell under \$1?
- This question has been raised at virtually every Conference. The basic reason for not introducing a cheap reprint is that the loss of book revenue might impair G.S.H. services. Book profits have meant the difference between continuing or curtailing these services a number of times.
17. The chairman was asked to explain the following expense items in the income statement for 1956: Bedford Hills expense, Television program, Honorarium, Writing and Research.
- The CPA who audits books of G.S.H. agencies provided detailed answers. (Note answer to #18)
18. What are the salaries of the full-time Staff members and what is the salary of the General Service Manager?
- Mr. Harrison, chairman of the G.S.B., asked the Conference if members would be satisfied to have such personal details disclosed to interested Delegates, on request, rather than broadcast. Conference members agreed unanimously to this arrangement. It was emphasized that any pertinent financial data will always be disclosed to Delegates upon request.
19. Can Delegates get a condensed report of the Conference, suitable for use in 15-minute Area reports?
- Delegates get detailed Conference report following closing session. All groups also get complete summaries of proceedings in two copies of "Conference Highlights" - 4-page digest.

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS (Continued)

20. What is the origin of the Serenity Prayer?
- A Delegate announced that a pamphlet on the prayer was available from a group in his Area. Available on request. G.S.H. will forward inquiries. (Pamphlet is interpretive, rather than historical.)
21. Value of "Exchange Bulletin" was questioned, with special reference to economic factors?
- Several Delegates commented that in their Areas it is "really liked," "wonderful," etc. One Delegate inquired about possibility of group subscriptions. Referred to General Service Committee.
22. Is it within Traditions to give report to local press on the Conference (Anonymously)?
- Agreed this would be within Tradition, based on discussion at 1956 Conference.
23. Several questions related to the propriety of local A.A.s taking active interest in pending legislation.
- Comments by a number of Delegates indicated that there are times when A.A.s, acting personally and individually but not representing A.A. as a movement, can be helpful on such matters.
24. Have ways of reducing the cost of the Conference been reviewed at G.S.H.?
- Yes. This cost is scrutinized continually. Basic question is whether specific economies would benefit Delegates and movement. G.S.H. is prepared to curtail or eliminate any phases of Conference that Delegates may suggest. After brief discussion, Conference affirmed informally its appreciation of way Conferences are being handled.
25. When will Bill revise the Third Legacy Manual and can it be combined with material from "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions?"
- Bill said he hoped to begin next year a small book-size manual bringing A.A. structural procedures and experience up to date. Manual would refer to local service set-ups, as well as to G.S.H.
26. Can special contributions be made Directly to Reserve Fund, on request?
- This can be done, but it presents certain listing and bookkeeping problems. Also, Reserve Fund is for emergencies; important to be sure current operating expenses are covered first.
27. Were the financial results of establishing "Gratitude Week" in 1956 successful?
- Moderately, but encouragingly.

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS (Continued)

28. What can be done about a group secretary who publicizes the group to latter's disadvantage, but who is thought by his followers to be doing good public relations job? Discussion of similar cases led to conclusion that this is matter of local autonomy.
29. Why not change Area "Delegates' Only" meeting from Thursday to Friday, to permit consideration of more subjects? Conference preferred continuing to meet on Thursday evenings.
30. What is Area experience with A.A. members who are employed, without special training, in public agencies dealing with alcoholics? Delegates from Maine, Oklahoma, Georgia, North Dakota, Massachusetts, Maryland, Vermont and Wisconsin commented on their knowledge and experience in this field. Point was made that where Commissions on Alcoholism start with large budgets, problems of politics and harmonious relationships develop more often than when initial appropriations are small. The sobriety of A.A.s did not appear to be affected when they took jobs of this type. In some areas, experience shows that officials "almost have to rely" on mature A.A.s to fill staffs with people who can make public programs function well. It was emphasized during comments by Delegates who themselves are on public pay-rolls, that they take such jobs as individuals, not as A.A.s in accordance with Tradition.
31. When G.S.H. Staff members speak at Area meetings, do they receive fees? No. Only out-of-pocket expenses covering travel, food and lodging.
32. Is a recording of Bill's talk on A.A. structure planned? Because of other commitments, Bill will have to defer projects of this type.
33. Do Areas prefer records or tapes? Tapes are preferred.
34. Did G.S.H. object when a comic strip sequence failed to indicate importance of Twelfth Step work? No. Net effect of strip was good. G.S.H. never tries to tell people what they should do---or should have done.
35. How can "pirating" of A.A. talks on tapes be prevented? Agreed best way to handle this is to be sure speaker approves of taping.
36. How about G.S.H. setting up a tape rental library? Agreed that tape recordings are a service that can be provided most effectively by individual members or groups and that there appears to be no compelling demand for G.S.H. to provide this service.

CONFERENCE NOTES

Information on Washington, D.C. Study

The Delegate from the District of Columbia reported informally on a significant study conducted by the District's "Committee on Prisons, Probation and Parole", appointed by the Board of Commissioners. Alcoholics Anonymous was one of a number of rehabilitative agencies cited in the Committee's report, which indicates that certain categories of offenders can be dealt with effectively and constructively without incarceration.

Portfolio for Delegates

Upon registering Wednesday, each Delegate received a 10-section portfolio of background information on the Conference in a looseleaf binder. Included in the material were advance digests of reports on all General Service Headquarters operations.

Turnover Presentation

A feature of Friday afternoon's discussion of ways in which Delegates might report G.S.H. services to groups in their areas was a special demonstration by Hank G., General Service Committee chairman. Hank used the large turnover presentation developed by Headquarters in 1953. Following inquiries by several Delegates it was announced that a limited number of the turnovers are still available at \$25.00 each, below production cost.

Suggestions for Reporting to Areas

Delegates were given an opportunity to discuss a mimeographed memorandum, "Reporting to the Areas on the Conference." Step-by-step approaches to such reporting, based on successful experience of previous Delegates, were outlined.

Meeting Procedures

Delegates voted to open all morning sessions with the Serenity Prayer and close all afternoon sessions with the Lord's Prayer.

Survey on Hospitalization Programs

A draft of a new survey on "A.A. - Hospital Cooperation" was distributed to Delegates.

DISPOSITION OF HEADQUARTERS REPORTS

After having been given more than 24 hours to review the verbal and written reports of General Service Headquarters Staff members and Committee chairmen, the Conference took the following action in each case:

Report of the Conference Secretary -- Approved without comment.

General Service Headquarters Report -- Approved without comment.

Public Relations Report -- After extended discussion of procedures that might be followed in the cases of those who abuse the Directory for commercial purposes, it was agreed that handling of the matter should be left to the discretion of Staff members and that local groups and individual members will be asked to join in protesting such exploitation.

Group Relations Report -- Approved, following discussion of possibility of listing State Committees in Directory; agreed that, because of difficulty of keeping these listings up-to-date, this action should not be taken.

Foreign Relations Report -- Approved without comment.

Report on Work with Institutions -- Approved without comment.

Public Information Committee Report -- The Conference agreed that General Service Headquarters should make available to Delegates, upon request, copies of the Basic Fact File recently developed by the Committee.

Policy Committee Report -- The Conference agreed that: The Committee should continue to review proposals referred to it by Delegates, with the understanding that if the Committee felt that a proposal should not, for one reason or another, be distributed to Delegates, said proposal should then be referred to the Agenda Committee of the Conference for further review; and, further, that if the Agenda Committee concurred in withholding the proposal from distribution, the Delegate responsible for the proposal should then be advised of his freedom to introduce the proposal on the floor of the Conference itself.

Literature Committee Report -- Approved, with the notation that the "Area Delegates Only" meeting had approved preparation of a pamphlet on "old timers" and a pamphlet on the individual and the Fellowship.

Finance and Budgetary Report -- Approved without comment.

NEW BY-LAWS FOR G.S. BOARD APPROVED

One of the most important and significant Headquarters policy actions the past year was ratified by the Conference when the Delegates approved unanimously a unique new set of by-laws which had earlier been adopted by the Board itself on a contingent basis.

The distinctive feature of the by-laws is that they prescribe certain "ground rules" for the operation of the Board while avoiding "legalistic" details characteristic of such documents. The by-laws were drafted by Bernard B. Smith, distinguished international lawyer and a member of the Board. Mr. Smith had been chairman of the Board during the first six Conference years.

Discussing the "philosophy of approach" that underlies the new by-laws, Mr. Smith told the Delegates:

"We start with certain basic premises. Alcoholics Anonymous, in my view, is a spiritual way of life. It operates basically by traditions and principles. It has an unincorporated organization known as the General Service Conference of A.A., functioning under an 'extra-legal' document known as the Charter. On the other side we have the stark problem of complying with the laws of the State of New York, as a membership corporation.

"A Board of Trustees and the members of a membership corporation are unable to delegate their powers to people outside the organization. They must, in compliance with the law, exercise the authority vested in them by law. Thus the problem was how to write a set of by-laws that would recognize the fact that basic power lies in the Conference, that would recognize that this is a spiritual movement, that would nevertheless comply with the laws of the State of New York and that would avoid, at all costs, stratification that might result from a document so definitive in nature that, should the need for change arise, the Twelve Steps and the Twelve Traditions would be immobilized."

Mr. Smith said that, personally, he was unable to devise a document that did not recognize that A.A. was a spiritual movement. He noted that the draft presented for the approval of Delegates was the third since he had first attempted to apply this "philosophy of approach" to the problem of replacing the outmoded document first written in 1938, when the Board was founded (as The Alcoholic Foundation.)

PROPOSAL FOR GIFT EDITION OF "BIG BOOK" NOT APPROVED
SPECIAL APPEAL DURING "GRATITUDE WEEK" APPROVED
STYLE FOR LOCAL USE OF A.A. SYMBOL ADOPTED

At the 1956 Conference, Delegates had approved the recommendation of the Literature Committee that the suggestion for a leather-bound gift edition of the "Big Book" be tabled for re-consideration by the 1957 Conference. During the year, a formal proposal on this project was distributed to all Areas for analysis and discussion.

Discussion on the proposal during the 1957 Conference revealed strong and divergent opinions on this proposal, reflecting both Area opinion and individual Delegates' feelings. A show of hands indicated that probably a majority favored the proposal but, in the absence of relative unanimity, the Conference promptly accepted the suggestion of the chair that the discussion be terminated. It was apparent during the discussion that a number of Delegates felt that no additional publishing project should be permitted to detract from Area interest in Bill's forthcoming new book, "A.A. Comes of Age."

As had been done last year, the Conference voted unanimously in directing General Service Headquarters to designate Thanksgiving Week as "A.A. Gratitude Week." In this connection, it is to be suggested to groups that a special appeal for funds to support A.A.'s world services be made at local meetings.

Following a discussion of the possibility of having G.S.H. prepare and sell large-scale reproductions of the A.A. seal, the Conference recommended that actual production of the "blow-ups" be left to the Areas, for reasons of economy.

To assure uniformity in such local efforts, the Conference agreed that, in addition to initials, such symbols should contain the words "Recovery," "Unity" and "Service arranged in the following positions: the word "Recovery" to be parallel with the base of the triangle, the word "Unity" to be parallel with the left-hand leg of the triangle and the word "Service" to be parallel with the right-hand leg of the triangle.

The Conference also asked that editors of the Grapevine consider the possibility of using the A.A. symbol as a cover decoration in a future issue.

ENLARGEMENT AND PRICE INCREASE APPROVED FOR "GRAPEVINE"
QUESTION OF CHANGING RATIO OF TRUSTEES TABLED AGAIN

One of the most detailed and most significant Policy Sessions of the 1957 Conference was the one devoted to appraisal of the financial position of the Grapevine, A.A.'s monthly international publication.

After hearing special presentations by Bill, by Russ C., business manager, and by Louise S., assistant editor, supported by an analysis of financial projections by Dick S., the Conference agreed unanimously that the price of the magazine should be increased from 25 cents to 35 cents for single copies and from \$2.50 to \$3.50 for annual subscriptions, effective July 1, 1957. Prices in Canada will be the same as for the U. S. Prices of bulk mailings will be increased proportionately.

Bill told the Conference that he planned to work closely with Grapevine personnel on plans to enlarge the magazine from 48 to 64 pages and to strengthen the editorial and business staffs. He gave the Conference a preview of a letter to appear in the June issue, announcing the proposed changes and his plan to contribute special material on a monthly basis. Bill stressed the necessity of getting the financial affairs of the magazine in a position where it could weather an economic depression and be in a position to cope with continuing inflation.

It was pointed out that editorial handling of material in the "new" Grapevine will be "broadened and deepened," that new material and departments will become regular features and that some material of the type now appearing in the "Exchange Bulletin" will be developed for the magazine.

The 1956 Conference had supported the principle that the present ratio of Trustees on the General Service Board (eight non-alcoholic and seven alcoholics) should be retained but had then asked the Board to place the subject on the agenda at the 1958 Conference "so that a specific proposal can be relayed to the groups with the understanding that no Conference action will be sought until 1958."

Accordingly, the matter was presented to the Conference at two sessions. The first featured a review of the problem by Bill and Mr. Leonard V. Harrison, non-alcoholic chairman of the Board. Bill voiced his belief that the movement, now more mature than at the time the ratio concept was adopted, should be prepared to assume full responsibility for decisions affecting its custodial affairs. The matter was presented to the Delegates again at the Saturday afternoon session of the Conference. After brief discussion of the importance of the subject, the Conference agreed, by a wide margin, to table the matter for consideration at the 1958 Conference.

"AREA DELEGATES ONLY" MEETING

As is Traditional at all Conferences, one session was set aside solely for deliberations of Area Delegates. Trustees and all Headquarters staff people were excluded.

Actions taken and matters discussed at the 1957 "Area Delegates Only" meeting included the following:

1. Endorsement of the G.S.B. Literature Committee suggestion that pamphlets be developed on the subject of "old-timers" and the relationship of individual members to the movement and its service agencies.
2. Endorsement of Bill's negotiations designed to make it possible to retail his forthcoming book, "A.A. Comes of Age," at \$4.00, if practical.
3. Approval of the suggestion of the Finance and Budgetary Committee that contributions from individual members be limited to \$100. in one year.
4. Designation of a "Hospitality Committee" for the 1958 Conference, comprising the following Delegates: Norsworthy (North Florida), Wolfe (Columbus, Ohio), Anderson (North New Jersey), Hiers (Alabama), Rogerson (Central Michigan), Rose (Connecticut) and Hicks (South Florida).
5. Selection by lot of Earl Paxton (Western Missouri) as Chairman of the 1958 "Area Delegates Only" meeting.
6. A suggestion that the scope of Conference committee work be outlined for new Delegates prior to the selection of members.

The Delegates also discussed procedures desirable in cases where vendors misuse the "Handbook and Directory," methods used to select Delegates in various Areas, the need for clarification of the relationship of G.S.B. committees to Conference committees and problems involved in having the G.S.B. Policy Committee review proposals submitted from the Areas.

COMMITTEE ON FINANCE

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON FINANCE

The Committee recognizes several basic financial problems:

1. G.H.S. worldwide services have been growing faster than Headquarters income.
2. Contribution requested of \$2.00 per member has never been increased, even though we now contribute in inflated dollars.
3. Many, if not most, members do not know what the G.S.H. Services are, and frequently tend to feel that "New York doesn't need the money," because they do not know what the money is used for.

On the other hand, it has been the general experience in A.A. that whenever members do understand what money is needed for, they have no hesitancy in contributing.

The over-all problem of providing sufficient funds to operate the G.H. Services is a matter of education. The central problem is how to tell every individual A.A. member why the money is needed.

The Committee makes the following suggestions:

1. That all delegates urge all of their committeemen to do everything they can to tell every member of every group what G.S.H. does, and what it uses the money for.
2. That G.S.H. furnish each delegate with a summary of Headquarters' services and expenditures. Each delegate should have enough copies to furnish one copy to each committeeman and each group secretary.
3. That Groups be urged to collect 20¢ per month per member and send it in to G.S.H. every month, rather than twice a year. In this connection, the Group fund envelopes are excellent.

Let's all go back and arrange for every group and every member in our respective areas to know what G.S.H. is and what it does. Let's help them understand, as we do, that it is our services that perpetuate the A.A., that our services are necessary to our survival, that it is an extension of our own Twelfth Step work. Let's ask every member if he wants to share in the work that saved his life!

COMMITTEE ON THE GRAPEVINE
COMMITTEE ON LITERATURE
COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON THE GRAPEVINE

The Grapevine Committee wholeheartedly endorsed the decision to increase the price of the magazine from 25¢ to 35¢ for single copies, and from \$2.50 to \$3.50 for yearly domestic subscriptions, with proportionate increases in foreign sales prices, as a necessity for the financial survival of the Grapevine.

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON LITERATURE

The Committee recommends:

- That since the Area Delegates at their meeting unanimously approved Bill's new book, it be adequately priced, \$4.50 not being too high.
- That since the Area Delegates at their meeting approved the suggested pamphlets for the "old-timer" and for the individual member's relationship to the structure of A.A., the title "What Kind of an Old-Timer Are You?" is preferred for the "old-timer" pamphlet and "You and Your 199,999 Partners in A.A." is approved for the other.
- That consideration be given to the possibility of developing material for a pamphlet to include case histories for the skid row alcoholic, a pamphlet that might be available in jails. Furthermore, when an outline or treatment of such a pamphlet is ready, it be submitted to the members of the Conference Literature Committee for comment.
- That at least once a year, an announcement be made in the "A.A. Exchange Bulletin" that specially-priced gift packages of A.A. literature are available for Prison and Hospital Groups.

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES

The Committee approves:

The election of Professor Harrison M. Trice and Dr. Harry M. Tiebout as Class "A" Trustees to fill vacancies created by the resignations of Jack Alexander and Frank B. Amos; and recommends:

The election of Charles Brown and John Park Lee as Class "B" Trustees to fill vacancies upon the expiration of the terms of Adam Capeling and Cliff Walker, and the election of Richard A. Stevens as a Class "B" Trustee to fill the vacancy created by the resignation of Sigurd B. Sandmore

(All Trustees are subject to re-election each year. Class "B" (non-alcoholic) Trustees traditionally serve no more than four one-year terms.)

COMMITTEE ON CONFERENCE REPORT AND CHARTER
COMMITTEE ON POLICY

REPORT OF COMMITTEE ON CONFERENCE REPORT AND CHARTER

The Committee recommends that the first draft of the Conference report be reviewed by all Conference Delegates and that suggestions and comments be sent to the Conference Secretary before the deadline for the Final Report.

Bill has suggested that the third article of the Conference Charter, i.e., Conference Relations to A.A. (Second paragraph page 58 of the Third Legacy Manual), be amended to read: "But no change in article 12 of the Charter or in A.A. tradition or in the Twelve Steps of A.A. may be made with less than the written consent of three-quarters of the A.A. groups, as described in the resolution adopted by the 1955 Conference and Convention". If this amendment is made, the seventh paragraph on page 57 of the Third Legacy Manual must also be amended to read: "excepting, however, that any amendment of Article 12 of the Charter or of A.A.'s Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions must have the consent of A.A. groups as provided in Article 3 of the Charter". It was recommended that these amendments be made.

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON POLICY

The Policy Committee concurs in the resolution of the Conference that General Service Headquarters continue to suggest to groups that they write to individuals and companies involved in the mis-use of the Directory, requesting that they be removed from the mailing list and further:

Recommends that a story be carried in the "Exchange Bulletin" about mis-use of the Directory, phrased in such a way that it will help to define the A.A. purposes for which the Directory is intended.

Recommends that an explanation of what is entailed in serving on specific Conference Committees be made before each Committee is selected.

Wishes to remind Delegates to send proposals for Conference consideration to General Service Headquarters before January 10th, earlier if possible.

Suggests that Conference Committee members please answer, with comment, any question or proposal sent them during the year.

Suggests that a precedent be established whereby the Chairman of the Area Delegates meeting, at the opening of the meeting, ask each new Delegate to stand, be recognized and given an opportunity to speak. (Suggested time, not more than two minutes!)

COMMITTEE ON ADMISSIONS

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON ADMISSIONS TO THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

1. Since a Delegate to the Cincinnati, Ohio, Area was established in the Third Legacy pamphlet, and since the Ohio State Assembly has voted its approval, it is recommended that the request for a Delegate to represent the Cincinnati Area be approved. It is further recommended that the state be divided into four Assembly Areas and that a map be furnished Headquarters showing which groups are being represented by each Delegate.
2. The two Pennsylvania Delegates have advised this Committee that their state assembly has solved the problem of representation through the addition of Area assemblymen, and that they are not requesting a Delegate for the Central Area as suggested in the Third Legacy pamphlet. Pennsylvania will provide Headquarters with a map showing which groups are represented by Eastern and Western Delegates.
3. The Committee reviewed the complaint from some groups in Illinois that they were not represented in the election of a Delegate. The Committee recommends that the matter be referred back to the Illinois Delegates with the suggestion that the Third Legacy Plan be employed in the election of all Delegates.
4. After reviewing the request from a California Delegate for an additional Delegate from that state (tabled from the 1956 Conference) the Committee recommends:
 - A. That the Conference recognize the need for a fifth Delegate on the basis of A.A. population.
 - B. That California district assemblies determine the five Area divisions.
 - C. That after such determinations, California make a specific request to the next Conference, accompanied by a map showing groups represented in each Area, and assurances that an attempt has been made to cover the state with present Delegates and additional Area Committeemen.

COMMITTEE ON ADMISSIONS
(Continued)

5. The Committee recommends -- as a guide for future Admission Committees -- that a fact file be set up for committee use only, incorporating some of the basic considerations affecting the number of Delegates from a state, province, or territory:
 - A. The fact that a greater number of Delegates means less opportunity for each Delegate to take part in the deliberations of the Conference.
 - B. The fact that each request for an additional Delegate from a state opens the way for requests from other states.
 - C. These guides taken from the Third Legacy Manual:
 1. That no state or province should request an additional Delegate unless its A.A. population exceeds these limits:

Two Delegates serving up to 7000
Three Delegates serving up to 12,000
Four Delegates serving 14,000
Five Delegates serving 19,000
 2. That the factor of mileage in a state be taken into consideration in determining the number of Delegates representing a state.
 - D. Requests for admission to come from state, provincial, or territorial Committees as a whole -- rather than from an Area -- and that such requests provide this information:
 1. A map of the state or province or territory showing proposed divisions, A.A. population of each, and groups involved.
 2. Assurances that an attempt has been made to cover present Areas with present Delegates plus an additional number of area committeemen.

*

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The Committee reaffirms the fact that it cannot in any measure decide how state divisions shall be made or how Delegates shall be elected -- while it does recommend the Third Legacy Plan of elections.

COMMITTEE ON THE AGENDA

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON THE AGENDA

The Committee:

1. Voted to accept the Conference agenda "as is" and to review proposals during the coming year, with appropriate advices to G.S.H.
2. Recommended continuation of G.S.H. briefing sessions for new Delegates prior to opening of Conference deliberations.
3. Suggested that G.S.H. consider the use of a round badge for the 1958 Conference.
4. Expressed gratitude to Ann Macfarlane and Hank Grieme for efforts in behalf of the 1957 Conference.

INDEX TO APPENDICES

Appendix I	-	Digest of 1957 Conference Agenda . . .	48
Appendix II	-	1956 Group Contributions	49
Appendix III	-	Roster of Delegates	51
Appendix IV	-	Trustees and Headquarters Staff . . .	53
Appendix V	-	Committees of the 1957 Conference . .	54

DIGEST OF AGENDA OF SEVENTH ANNUAL GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE - 1957

WEDNESDAY, APRIL 17

- Evening -- Registration of Delegates ends
 Dinner for Delegates and Spouses
 Greetings from Leonard V. Harrison, Chairman
 Greetings from Bill W.
-

THURSDAY, APRIL 18

- Morning -- First Session - Reports on Year's Services
- Afternoon -- Second Session - Selection of Conference Committees
 Continuation of Reports
 Presentation by Bill W. on Structure of A.A.
- Evening -- Third Session (For Area Delegates Only)
-

FRIDAY, APRIL 19

- Morning -- Fourth Session - Area Problem
 Fifth Session
- Afternoon -- Report of General Service Board Chairman
 Consideration of Policy Proposal (Gift Edition)
-

SATURDAY, APRIL 20

- Morning -- Sixth Session - Panel Discussions
 "The Group, the Area and Their Public Relations"
 "Clubhouses"
- Afternoon -- Seventh Session - Special Reports
 Treasurer of General Service Board
 Grapevine
 Nominating Committee
 Policy Discussions
-

SUNDAY, APRIL 21

- Afternoon -- Eighth Session - Conference Committee Reports
 Closing talk by Leonard V. Harrison, Chairman
 Closing talk by Bill W.
-

1956 GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS
GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS FUND

<u>U.S.A. STATE</u>	<u>No. of Grps Reported</u>	<u>No. of Grps Contrib.</u>	<u>% of Grps Contrib.</u>	<u>Amount of Contrib.</u>	<u>Membership</u>	<u>Contrib. Per Capita</u>
Alabama	44	18	41%	\$ 1,187.00	1,044	\$ 1.14
Arizona	41	25	61	900.50	610	1.48
Arkansas	57	36	63	1,221.00	931	1.31
California	652	452	70	22,931.28	14,612	1.57
Colorado	53	32	60	1,851.13	1,132	1.64
Connecticut	59	38	65	1,777.00	1,159	1.53
Delaware	14	9	64	524.00	312	1.70
District of Columbia	14	12	86	496.63	753	.66
Florida	140	94	67	4,420.79	2,951	1.50
Georgia	60	35	58	1,705.25	1,119	1.52
Idaho	27	14	52	533.00	337	1.58
Illinois	407	328	81	4,953.50	6,406	.77
Indiana	127	127	100	2,903.90	1,825	1.59
Iowa	81	43	53	2,288.00	1,778	1.29
Kansas	73	49	67	2,035.00	1,451	1.40
Kentucky	48	36	75	1,641.50	667	2.46
Louisiana	49	25	51	1,281.00	881	1.45
Maine	37	24	65	692.63	530	1.31
Maryland	64	40	63	1,911.44	1,227	1.56
Massachusetts	139	91	70	4,198.95	2,682	1.57
Michigan	210	141	67	7,444.17	4,055	1.84
Minnesota	121	68	56	3,449.69	3,212	1.08
Mississippi	31	16	51	576.50	616	.94
Missouri	109	95	90	3,627.50	2,031	1.79
Montana	26	16	62	404.00	431	.94
Nebraska	40	25	63	725.00	479	1.51
Nevada	15	10	70	454.00	318	1.43
New Hampshire	22	14	64	468.00	277	1.70
New Jersey	150	81	54	3,306.35	2,503	1.32
New Mexico	28	14	50	495.00	586	.85
New York	330	198	60	10,462.93	7,589	1.38
North Carolina	118	72	61	3,616.79	2,241	1.61
North Dakota	36	14	40	393.00	468	.84
Ohio	316	160	51	6,740.08	7,782	.87
Oklahoma	64	44	70	2,789.00	1,183	2.36
Oregon	54	40	74	1,133.25	753	1.50
Pennsylvania	225	137	60	5,384.83	3,592	1.50
Rhode Island	16	11	70	285.00	223	1.28
South Carolina	55	25	46	672.00	938	.72
South Dakota	34	22	65	686.00	548	1.25
Tennessee	38	23	61	1,033.50	790	1.31
Texas	242	131	54	10,264.76	5,037	2.04
Utah	42	21	50	609.50	700	.87
Vermont	20	10	50	364.00	310	1.17
Virginia	81	53	65	2,763.62	1,950	1.42
Washington	101	67	67	2,528.53	1,706	1.48
West Virginia	45	28	62	1,123.00	731	1.54
Wisconsin	123	96	78	3,289.73	2,039	1.61
Wyoming	15	13	87	328.25	164	2.00
Armed Forces Loners				5.00	2	
Total For U.S.A.	4893	3173	65%	\$ 134,876.48	95,661	\$ 1.41

1956 GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS
GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS FUND
(Continued)

CANADA

Alberta	54	33	61%	\$ 1,015.15	664	\$ 1.53
British Columbia	102	68	67	3,830.32	1,772	2.16
Manitoba	25	19	76	1,386.26	676	2.05
New Brunswick	22	9	41	239.77	689	.35
Newfoundland	8	4	50	118.58	110	1.08
Nova Scotia	37	25	68	631.61	575	1.10
Ontario	222	122	55	5,122.18	3,472	1.48
Prince Edward Isle	6	4	67	91.00	96	.95
Quebec	94	52	55	1,697.11	1,526	1.11
Saskatchewan	52	31	60	725.89	635	1.14
Yukon Territory	1	1	100	16.00	16	1.00
Northwest Territories	1				4	
Total For Canada	624	368	59%	\$ 14,873.87	10,235	\$ 1.45
Total For U.S.A. and Canada	5,517	3,541	64%	\$149,750.35	105,896	\$ 1.43

FOREIGN

710	\$ 2,401.98	14,988
-----	-------------	--------

*LONE MEMBERS

689.51

INTERNATIONALISTS

341.59	141
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HOSPITAL GROUPS.

256	252.85	5,936
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PRISON GROUPS

296	269.50	12,837
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GRAND TOTAL

6,779	\$153,016.27	139,798
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* Contributions of Lone Members included in State, Province and Foreign totals.

GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
ROSTER OF DELEGATES
1957

Alabama	(7)	<u>Hiers, Jim E.</u> , 1601 Woodview Drive, Huntsville
Arkansas	(7)	<u>Porter, James S.</u> , 300 Rector Street, Little Rock
Arizona	(6)	<u>Davis, John</u> , 4036 E. Fairmont, Phoenix
California	(7)	Los Angeles - <u>Christianson, Glenn</u> , 2390 Glen Canyon Rd., Altadena
	(6)	San Diego - <u>Stout, O. L. (Bud)</u> , 4479 30th St., San Diego
	(6)	Sacramento - <u>Masterson, James E.</u> , 4509 - 37th Ave., Sacramento
	(7)	San Francisco - <u>Gardner, Paul</u> , 1612 Fourth St., San Rafael
Colorado	(7)	<u>Wilson, James L.</u> , 4154 Xavier Street, Denver 12
Connecticut	(7)	<u>Rose, John J.</u> , 34 Deepwood Drive, Cheshire
Delaware	(6)	<u>Potts, Herbert</u> , 2925 N. Harrison St., Wilmington,
District of Col.	(7)	<u>Stonebraker, Barse</u> , 1835 K St., N. W., Washington, D. C.
Florida	(7)	North - <u>Norsworthy, L. W. (Pap)</u> , Box 673, Neptune Beach
	(7)	South - <u>Hicks, Dora</u> , 4800 N. W. 5th Street, Miami 34
Georgia	(6)	<u>O'Brien, James P.</u> , 723 East 57th Street, Savannah
Idaho	(6)	<u>Smith, H. Lyle</u> , 215 South Lincoln Street, Pocatello
Illinois	(7)	Chicago - <u>Forman, Chandler</u> , 848 Ridge Avenue, Evanston
	(6)	Decatur - <u>Whitney, Richard</u> , Box 77, Quincy
	(7)	Springfield - <u>Ansell, Oscar</u> , 1829 South Pasfield, Springfield
Indiana	(7)	<u>Cates, Harry</u> , 313 South Meridian St., Washington
Iowa	(7)	<u>Doolittle, Niles</u> , 609 Otsego St., Storm Lake
Kansas	(6)	<u>Mai, Adam</u> , 125 Maple, Russell
Kentucky	(6)	<u>Breyley, Naomi</u> , Route 2, Manitou
Louisiana	(7)	<u>Kelley, Thomas B.</u> , Box 1612, Shreveport
Maine	(6)	<u>Hastings, Rowland J., Jr.</u> , Box 281, Augusta
Maryland	(6)	<u>Loftus, Mike</u> , 1723 N. Montford Avenue, Baltimore 13
Massachusetts	(7)	Boston - <u>Ryan, Ed.</u> , 9 Emerson Street, Belmont
	(6)	Springfield - <u>Shea, J. Anthony</u> , 28 Prospect Street, Ware
Michigan	(7)	East - <u>Golden, Daniel</u> , 19264 Omira St., Detroit 3
	(7)	Central - <u>Rogerson, Robert</u> , 608 North Magnolia, Lansing
	(6)	West - <u>Meagher, Jack</u> , 82 South 22nd Street, Battle Creek
Minnesota	(6)	North - <u>Hall, Waldo</u> , Box 245, Staples
	(7)	South - <u>Swenson, Alf A.</u> , Wilder
Mississippi	(6)	<u>Breen, Richard</u> , Box 1041, Jackson
Missouri	(7)	East - <u>Crane, Bob</u> , 101 Monroe St., Jefferson City
	(7)	West - <u>Paxton, Earl</u> , 710 West Second St., Sedalia
Montana	(6)	<u>Reece, Joseph</u> , 1101 Maryland Avenue, Butte
Nebraska	(6)	<u>Farrell, Don</u> , 108 South 53rd Street, Omaha
Nevada	(7)	
New Hampshire	(6)	<u>Devine, Henry</u> , 30 Cheney Place, Manchester
New Jersey	(7)	North - <u>Anderson, Tom</u> , 152 Grove Avenue, Woodbridge
	(6)	South - <u>Pebley, Gleason</u> , Georgetown Road, Penns Grove

(Continued)

GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
ROSTER OF DELEGATES
1957
(Continued)

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<u>New York</u>	(7)	<u>New York City - Frylink, Adrian</u> , Box 66, Babylon
	(6)	<u>Buffalo - Matthews, James</u> , Custer City, Pennsylvania
	(6)	<u>Albany - Harrica, Thomas</u> , 13 Pine Street, Whitesboro
	(7)	<u>Rochester - McNulty, Ed.</u> , 761 Valentine Street, Elmira
<u>North Carolina</u>	(7)	<u>Pegg, Willard</u> , 1911 Spring Garden Street, Greensboro
<u>North Dakota</u>	(6)	<u>Olsen, Harve</u> , 512 First Avenue, South, New Rockford
<u>Ohio</u>	(7)	<u>Columbus - Wolfe, Pete</u> , Gahanna
	(6)	<u>Toledo - Evans, Edward M.</u> , 3009 Fulton Street, Toledo
	(7)	<u>Akron--Cleveland - Bennhoff, Howard</u> , West Richfield, (P.O. Box 456)
<u>Oklahoma</u>	(7)	<u>Jay, Ruben</u> , 501 Washington, Stillwater
<u>Oregon</u>	(6)	<u>Beveridge, Paul</u> , 2010 S. E. Sherman, Portland
<u>Pennsylvania</u>	(7)	<u>East - Hand, Horace S.</u> , 312 West 4th Street, Williamsport
	(7)	<u>West - Sargent, Jack</u> , 220 Emerson Avenue, Pittsburgh 15
<u>Rhode Island</u>	(6)	<u>Head, John</u> , 132 Cato Street, Woonsocket
<u>South Carolina</u>	(6)	<u>Griffith, H. P.</u> , Cornell Arms, Columbia
<u>South Dakota</u>	(6)	<u>Davey, Dan D.</u> , Locke Hotel, Pierre
<u>Tennessee</u>	(6)	<u>Hill, Maryan E.</u> , 234 Hawthorne, Memphis 12
<u>Texas</u>	(7)	<u>Dallas - Henderson, William R.</u> , 1614 N. Fitzhugh, Dallas
	(7)	<u>Houston - Muse, J. P.</u> , 2007 Chippendale, Houston
	(6)	<u>Corpus Christi - Moran, Joseph J.</u> , 1434 Nix Prof. Bldg., San Antonio
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<u>West Virginia</u>	(7)	<u>Javins, Charles G.</u> , 1220 Baines Street, Charleston 1
<u>Wisconsin</u>	(7)	<u>Raymond, Theodore C.</u> , 323 West Wilson St., Madison
	(6)	<u>N. Wisc. & Upper Mich. - Clarkieu, George</u> , Box 379, Green Bay
<u>Wyoming</u>	(6)	<u>May, Don</u> , Box 35, Douglas
<u>Canada</u>	(6)	<u>Alberta - McLean, Frank J.</u> , 6525 - 107th St., Edmonton
	(7)	<u>B. C. - Russell, Mark</u> , 21 Government Street, Victoria
	(6)	<u>Manitoba - Ferguson, Don</u> , 6 Wakefield Apts., Winnipeg
	(6)	<u>Maritime Provinces - Dower, Doug.</u> , Box 622, Chatham, New Brunswick
	(7)	<u>Ontario - McVicar, Neil</u> , 761 Crawford Street, Toronto
	(6)	<u>Quebec - Bonneville, Pierre</u> , 3430 Fullum Street, Montreal
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<u>Puerto Rico</u>	(6)	<u>Bonet, Bartolome</u> , Granada St. #195, Urbanizacion Valencia, Rio Piedras,

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